Resolution

Like most other things in the tablet world, the new iPad has set the standard here - 2048x1536 pixels packed into a vibrant 9.7-inch IPS LCD screen. In terms of resolution, this might well be a ceiling at this size. In the coming year, we will see other companies doing their best to catch up with these numbers. They probably will, but we only hope they take lesser time than they took catching up with pixel density on the iPhone 4. But pixels are just half the story.

Display Technologies

The screen on the new iPad looks as brilliant as it is sharp, but we definitely know that there are technologies out there that can outmatch it. The backlight-less AMOLED screens from Samsung are much more power efficient and deliver lusciously dark blacks. Giving a Super-AMOLED+ this huge pixel density could create a display that might dethrone the iPad's.

Another display technology for the future is colour e-ink, and there is speculation that Amazon has already ordered a batch of E-Ink's Triton colour e-ink displays for its next generation of e-readers.

3rd Dimension?

At some point of time, some company will come up with a tablet sporting a glasses-free 3D display a la Nintendo 3DS. While the lack of content has caused 3D-touting smartphones to flop badly, the bigger display on tablets might just save the Nth reincarnation of 3D. This is majorly because a lot of movies are already available in 3D, and the tablets might just offer a more tempting display than smartphones to watch these. And if the trend catches up, other content will surely follow suite.

Screen Coating

No matter how good the screens are, it all becomes useless when you have a distracting oil smudge or a bright reflection. While matte screens (or screen protectors) are an alternative for some, we think the higher contrast ratio on glossy screens means that no manufacturer would dare ship a tablet with a matte screen. Luckily, there are alternatives that reduce reflections and smudges without resorting to matte.

Japanese chemical firm Toray has developed a special oleophobic layer with nano-wrinkles, which it showcased Nano Tech 2012 held in Japan in February. Unlike the largely ineffectic oleophobic coatings that the